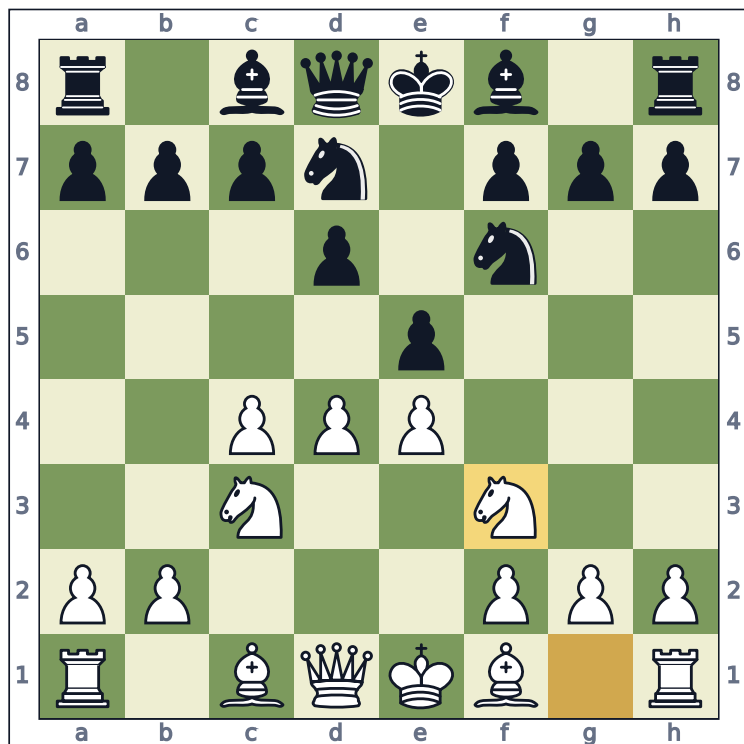


BENONI, BENKO, AND INDIAN STRUCTURES

Old Indian Defense

ECO A55 | 1 named line in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.60 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

A55 covers Old Indian Defense. The center becomes asymmetric: White often owns space, while Black seeks dynamic files, diagonals, and pawn breaks. The diagram uses the featured line Old Indian Defense: Normal Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 Nbd7 4. e4 e5 5. Nf3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, finish development, support e4, and prepare a central or queenside expansion without overextending.

BLACK'S GOALS

Attack the pawn center with ...e6, ...c5, or ...b5, activate the dark-squared bishop, and create counterplay before White consolidates.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White commonly uses e5 or b4; Black's thematic resources include ...e6, ...b5, and sometimes ...f5.

PIECE MAP

White's central pawns need piece support. Black's bishops and rooks become strong when files open on the queenside. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Space is valuable but can become a target. A premature pawn advance may leave weak squares behind it. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Good for ambitious players: strategically rich and fully playable, but many lines require comfort with imbalance.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A55 line

This section preserves all 1 names and defining routes assigned to A55 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

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Old Indian Defense: Normal Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 Nbd7 4. e4 e5 5. Nf3